

# Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

## Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

## Customer Details

Name: Mr Dhaval Rathod

Address: 30 Sackville Mews Sackville Road Sutton SM2 6HS

## Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer objects to the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: Planning Objection - Former Sutton Ambulance Station, Dorset Road

I object to the proposed development on the grounds that it represents an inappropriate and incompatible use within a wholly residential area and would result in significant harm to residential amenity and local character, contrary to established planning policy.

The proposal introduces a high intensity place of worship and community use into a location characterised entirely by low density residential development. The scale, hours of operation, and expected levels of attendance are incompatible with the surrounding land use and would materially alter the established residential character of the area.

The proposed extensions and increase in building height would result in a visually dominant and overbearing form of development, out of keeping with the prevailing domestic scale, massing, and appearance of neighbouring properties, causing harm to townscape character.

There is no demonstrated unmet need for this development. Similar facilities exist within close proximity, and the site is located in an area of very poor public transport accessibility (PTAL 1a), making it unsuitable for a high capacity use reliant on large numbers of visitors.

The proposal raises serious concerns regarding noise and disturbance, particularly from late evening activities and large scale dispersal of attendees, which would result in unacceptable harm to neighbouring occupiers' living conditions.

In addition, the development would lead to unacceptable parking stress and traffic impact, due to insufficient onsite parking provision and reliance on surrounding residential streets, adversely affecting highway safety and residential convenience.

Taken cumulatively, the intensity of use, noise, traffic, parking pressure, and extended hours of operation would cause substantial and lasting harm to residential amenity and neighbourhood character.

## Conclusion

The proposal fails to respect the character of the area, does not adequately protect residential amenity, and represents an unsustainable form of development in this location.

For these reasons, the application should be refused.